DO YOU KNOW?

There are over 30000 species of weeds around the world. Out of these 18000 species cause serious losses to crops. The continuous use of the same method leads to building up of tolerant species. Therefore, a suitable combination of different methods of weed control should be practiced.

Integrated weed management

Integrated weed management combines different agronomic practices and herbicides use to manage weeds, so that the reliance on any one weed control technique is reduced. Mechanical, biological, cultural and chemical methods are included in integrated weed managements.

21.2.6 Harvesting of Crops

The process of cutting and gathering a crop is called **harvesting**. Different methods are used for harvesting.

Manual harvesting

This is the major method of harvesting in India. Certain crops are harvested without using tools. Crops like ground nut, green gram, black gram and horse gram can be harvested by uprooting with hand, provided soil moisture is adequate for hand pulling.

Mechanical method

Harvesting in our country is generally done by employing the labours with the help of farm instruments like sickle. This method is a laborious and time-consuming one and it is suitable for small-sized farms only.



Figure 21.12 Mechanical method

Machine harvesting

This harvesting method is used in large sized agriculture fields.



Figure 21.13 Machine harvesting

The term harvesting also includes the immediate post-harvest practices such as threshing and winnowing.

The process of separating the grains from their chaffs or pods is threshing. After threshing, we must separate the grains from the chaffs. Winnowing is the process of separating the grains.



Threshing Winnowing

Figure 21.14 Separation of grains

21.2.7 Storage of food grains

Storage is an important aspect of post-harvest technology, because the crop is seasonally produced but consumed through out the year. Therefore, supply of the produce has to be maintained by proper storage. Before storing, harvested grains should be made free from moisture. Any moisture in the stored grins will lead to the growth of microorganism. So they need to be dried in the sun before storing. Food grains are collected in gunny bags and then stored in godowns. Silos and grains are

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